CASE STUDY 13 — ENTERPRISE PROCESS AUTOMATION

Building Approval-Based Workflow Automation in Zoho Creator

PLATFORM	ENGINE	HIERARCHY	AUDIT CONTROL
Zoho Creator C6	Approvals & Deluge Workflows	Multi-Tier Conditional	Automated Audit Trail

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Automating approval hierarchies eliminates operational bottlenecks, ensures governance compliance, and accelerates business decision-making. Zoho Creator provides native approval process builders combined with Deluge scripting to handle conditional routing, escalation timers, multi-level authorizations, and real-time status updates. This case study details the implementation of a multi-stage approval workflow for enterprise purchase requests.

Multi-Tier	Automated	100%
CONDITIONAL APPROVAL HIERARCHY	EMAIL & MOBILE NOTIFICATIONS	TRACEABLE AUDIT LOGGING

2. APPROVAL WORKFLOW ARCHITECTURE & STATE TRANSITION

The approval lifecycle manages transitions between record submission, manager evaluation, executive sign-off, and final status logging.



3. APPROVAL RULE MATRIX & MULTI-LEVEL CRITERIA

The table below outlines the threshold matrix determining approval routing pathways and notification triggers configured within Zoho Creator.

Approval Level	Evaluation Condition	Designated Approver	Action on Approve	Action on Reject
Level 1 (Direct)	Request Amount < $5,000	Direct Department Manager	Set Status: "Approved"; Notify Vendor	Set Status: "Rejected"; Email Initiator
Level 2 (Executive)	Request Amount >= $5,000	Finance Director / VP	Set Status: "Approved"; Trigger PO Generation	Set Status: "Rejected"; Return to Initiator
Escalation Rule	Pending > 48 Hours	System Admin / Secondary Manager	Auto-reassign and send reminder email	N/A
Emergency Bypass	Priority == "Critical"	CFO Direct Override	Immediate notification and authorization	N/A

4. DELUGE SCRIPTING FOR APPROVAL HOOKS & AUDIT TRAIL

> **Approval Action Trigger:** Automatically append approver comments, timestamp, and authorization signature into the immutable Audit Trail sub-form upon status change.

Executed Deluge Post-Approval Hook Script

```
      // Post-Approval Deluge Script Event if (input.Approval_Status == "Approved") { // Write entry to Audit Log insert into Audit_Log_History [ Related_Request_ID = input.ID, Approver_Email = zoho.loginuserid, Action_Taken = "Approved", Action_Timestamp = zoho.currenttime, Comments = input.Approver_Comments ]; // Trigger Notification to Requestor sendmail [ from : zoho.adminemail to : input.Requested_By.Email subject : "Request Approved: " + input.Request_Title message : "Your purchase request has been approved by " + zoho.loginuser ]; }
```

5. BUSINESS OUTCOMES & PROCESS OPTIMIZATION

Implementing approval-based workflow automation in Zoho Creator reduces cycle times from days to minutes, eliminates lost requests, and enforces corporate compliance. The combination of declarative low-code approval builders with Deluge script extensibility ensures seamless handling of complex business requirements across desktop and mobile devices.